FARHAN'S 10-MONTH SCHOLARSHIP ROADMAP

HSC Exam + International University Applications

- **Timeline:** August 18, 2026 → June 30, 2027 (10 months)
- **Primary Goal:** HSC Exam (Target: 85%+) + Scholarship Applications
- **Tech Focus:** Atlas case study + AI Document Intelligence project + Free cloud learning
- **Portfolio:** Atlas (web + Android) + 2 projects + 3 blog posts + GitHub
- **Financial:** $0 spent on courses or certifications

Created: August 17, 2026

Executive Summary

Your Reality: You have 10 months, limited budget, but strong technical skills (Atlas is done!), strong English, and determination. Your first year at Milestone College was wasted, but you're making up for it now.

Your Strategy: Focus ruthlessly on 3 things:
1. **HSC Exam (70% of effort)** - Must score 85%+ for scholarship success
2. **University Applications (20% of effort)** - Submit 8-12 applications Nov-Jan
3. **Technical Portfolio (10% of effort)** - Polish Atlas + build 1 strong project

What NOT to do: Chase certifications (AZ-900, AI-901 exams are $99 each). You can study free on Microsoft Learn, but save the paid exams for after HSC.

Weekly Time Allocation: 6-8 hours/week for tech, 35-56 hours/week for HSC (depending on phase), 1-4 hours/week for applications, 0-2 hours/week for freelancing.

By June 2027, you'll have: Strong HSC score (85%+), IELTS 6.5+, 2 portfolio projects, 3 blog posts, 8-12 university acceptances, and 3-4 scholarship offers.

PHASE 1: August 18 - September 30 (Foundation)

Focus: HSC Kickoff + Portfolio Polish | **Tech:** 6 hrs/week | **HSC:** 35 hrs/week

- **HSC:** Get past papers (5 years), weekly mocks, daily 5-6 hours study
- **Tech:** Atlas case study (2-3 hrs), Blog post #1 (2.5 hrs), GitHub cleanup (1.5 hrs), Microsoft Learn start (1 hr)
- **Apps:** Research 15-20 universities, identify deadlines
- **IELTS:** Take diagnostic test (3 hrs)

PHASE 2: October - November (Test Exam #1 + Cloud)

Focus: Free Test Exam + Azure Fundamentals | **Tech:** 7 hrs/week | **HSC:** 42 hrs/week

- **OCT 2026 CRITICAL:** Free test exam #1 - treat like real HSC
- **HSC:** Weekly mocks, daily 6-7 hours, drill weak areas from Oct exam
- **Tech:** Azure fundamentals (AZ-900 path on Microsoft Learn), start Project #2 planning (4 hrs/week)
- **Apps:** Draft personal statement
- **IELTS:** 2 practice tests (1 per month)

PHASE 3: December - January (Application Sprint)

Focus: Submit 8-12 University Applications | **Tech:** 5 hrs/week | **HSC:** 30 hrs/week

- ■■ **CRITICAL:** Dec 15 - Jan 31: Submit 8-12 applications (aim for 85%+ schools only)
- **Apps:** Personal statement final draft, submit applications with predicted grades from Oct exam
- **HSC:** Continue drilling weak areas, weekly mocks (6-7 hrs/day)
- **Tech:** Finish Azure fundamentals, start building Project #2 (AI Document Intelligence) - 5 hrs/week
- **IELTS:** Register for Feb/March exam, practice 1-2 hrs/week

PHASE 4: February - March (Exam Responses + Crunch)

Focus: HSC Final Prep + University Responses | **Tech:** 2 hrs/week | **HSC:** 50 hrs/week

- **HSC:** MAXIMUM EFFORT: Daily 7-8 hours, weekly mocks in ALL subjects, sleep 7-8 hrs
- **Tech:** Finish Project #2, deploy on Vercel/Netlify, write blog post #2 (2 hrs/week only)
- **IELTS:** Results come back (6.5+ expected)
- **Universities:** Track responses (don't celebrate/panic yet - focus on HSC)

PHASE 5: April - May (Test Exam #2 + Final Sprint)

Focus: HSC Maximum Effort | **Tech:** 0 hrs | **HSC:** 56 hrs/week

- **APR/MAY 2027:** Free test exam #2 (2 months before HSC) - final benchmark

- **HSC:** COMPLETE FOCUS: Daily 8 hours, timed papers, subject drills, sleep 8 hrs
- **Tech:** PAUSE. Nothing. Portfolio is ready. Save mental energy for HSC
- **Universities:** Most acceptances decided by now

PHASE 6: June - July (HSC Exam + Decisions)

Focus: HSC Exam + Scholarship Finalization | **Tech:** 0 hrs | **HSC:** 60 hrs

- **JUNE 2027:** HSC Examination - Target 85%+
- **Results:** HSC results come back (mid-July)
- **Universities:** Final acceptances + scholarship amounts
- **July onwards:** Choose university, begin visa application process

Weekly Time Breakdown (Hours per Week)

Phase	Dates	HSC	Tech	IELTS	Apps	Freelance	Sleep
1	Aug-Sep	35h	6h	0.5h	2h	1h	56h
2	Oct-Nov	42h	7h	1h	3h	1h	56h
3	Dec-Jan	30h	5h	1h	15h	0h	56h
4	Feb-Mar	50h	2h	1h	2h	0h	49h
5	Apr-May	56h	0h	0h	0h	0h	56h
6	Jun-Jul	60h	0h	0h	2h	0h	42h

Total over 10 months: HSC (273 hrs) | Tech (20 hrs) | Apps (22 hrs) | IELTS (3.5 hrs)

Your Portfolio by June 2027

■ **Atlas** - Full-stack AI OS (web + Android APK, Netlify deployed)

■ **Atlas Case Study** - 3,000+ words explaining architecture + challenges solved

■ **AI Document Intelligence Project** - RAG application with PDF extraction + embeddings + LLM

■ **3 Technical Blog Posts** - Demonstrating communication + technical depth (Dev.to/Medium)

■ **4-5 University Acceptances** - With scholarship offers from top schools

■ **IELTS Score** - 6.5+ (proof of English proficiency)

■ **HSC Results** - 85%+ (strong academic foundation)

■ **Personal Statement** - Compelling story of resilience + growth (500-700 words)

■ **GitHub Profile** - Clean code, good documentation, active commits

■ **Fiverr Income** - 1-2 completed client projects + testimonials

This is a powerful, cohesive portfolio for international scholarship success.

The Golden Rule: Your Decision Filter

Before starting anything new, ask yourself:

"Does this help HSC, scholarship admission, employability, or income within the next 10 months?"

If the answer is **NO** → it goes to the **POST-HSC BACKLOG**.
If the answer is **YES** → you do it.

Decision Filter Examples:

Task	Helps in 10 months?	Decision
Build Atlas case study	YES (portfolio)	■ DO IT
Learn Azure fundamentals	YES (skills + portfolio)	■ DO IT
Learn Kubernetes	NO	■ POST-HSC
Learn AWS Solutions Architect	NO	■ POST-HSC
Take AZ-900 paid exam ($99)	NO (study free instead)	■■ STUDY FREE, SKIP EXAM
Complete HSC prep	YES (critical)	■ DO IT
Build AI Doc Intelligence project	YES (portfolio + skills)	■ DO IT
Learn Rust	NO	■ POST-HSC
Take paid online course	NO (budget)	■ SKIP

Quick Reference Timeline

**Aug 18 ■■■